



Security Watch

Opera Upgrade Recommended

The Problem

Users of Opera 8.1 may be at risk of attack. Security firm Secunia has uncovered a security weakness in that version. Researchers at Secunia said they found that a design error in the way Opera processes mouse clicks in new browser windows. This, combined with the predictability of the position of the 'File Download' dialog box, could be exploited to trick users into clicking the 'Open' button of a file download prompt, even if they intended to click 'Save' or 'Cancel'.

The exploit has only been verified to work in Opera version 8.01, though earlier versions may be vulnerable too.

The Damages

Naturally, you wouldn't want to click 'Open' for a file you intend to save and then virus-check. And if you're prompted to save or open a file from an untrusted source, you're more likely to click 'Cancel'! Hackers could use the weakness to trick users into downloading and running unwanted programs. The flaw cannot be taken lightly—running a malicious program could damage your computer!

The Solution

The flaw was eliminated in Opera version 8.02, but why not upgrade to the latest version—8.51? The update is available at www.opera.com/download.

designed in India, of which we've been hearing about for a long time—but of which nothing seems to materialise. AMD has not sold many of its cheap Internet devices—the Personal Internet Communicators—for the developing world.

But still, history has also taught us that some bad ideas meet with wild success, and that some great ideas fall flat.

The \$100 laptop could turn out to be a good idea that works. After all, it's targeted at children and students—and looking at the features on offer, who needs more? Even if the project can place a laptop in the hands of every twentieth child, it would have succeeded.

AWASH IN CONTROVERSY

Is Wikipedia Credible?

It was only a matter of time before an encyclopaedia based on the wiki concept became the subject of a controversy. It was a relatively minor incident that sparked it off, but the questions are now really being asked. Wikipedia, for those who came in late, is an online encyclopaedia that anyone—including you—can edit. And it currently has more than a million entries.

The incident we're talking about was an

anonymously-written biography entry that linked former *USA Today* editor John Seigenthaler Sr with the assassinations of President John F Kennedy and Senator Robert F Kennedy. The writer, Brian Chase, later issued an apology for his prank. Seigenthaler, in a *USA Today* editorial, criticised Wikipedia and called the fake biography "Internet character assassination."

In an interview with BusinessWeek Online, Jimmy Wales, Wikipedia founder and president of the Wikimedia Foundation, which runs Wikipedia, said they were revamping the process of entry creation so credibility could be maintained. Asked how users should view Wikipedia, he said, "It should be thought of as work in progress. It's our



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

HOT

Microsoft Xbox 360



The current darling of gamers, Xbox 360 is the most powerful game console in the market. Microsoft has re-built the 360 to provide an experience that leaves the competition gaping like a goldfish.

NOT

With the Playstation 3 still a few months away,



Top Dog Sony has been ingloriously knocked over by the Xbox 360 for now. Sony devotees must either shift loyalties to Microsoft or gnash their teeth in jealousy.

intention to be Britannica or better quality, and our policies and everything are designed with that goal in mind. We don't reach that

quality yet." Most tellingly, when asked if he thought students and researchers should cite Wikipedia, Wales issued a frank "No." But he went on to say he didn't think people should cite Britannica either.

When it comes to Wikipedia vs. Britannica, opinion on the Internet varies wildly. Some, including CNN, say Wikipedia is as accurate on science as the venerated Britannica. Others have cast doubt on Wikipedia's credibility even before this recent



One Silly Question

"Why is the mouse called a mouse?"



"It's a nice name for the device"
Preksha Sharma, Jaipur



"Since it's so tiny?"
Mona Dhumal, Pune



"Coz it looks like one!"
Sarosh Aziz Chougale, Ratnagiri



"It moves around like one"
Priya Talreja, Mumbai



"It couldn't be called a cat"
Akanksha Srivastavi, Delhi